

173 Shape an ivy man

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Clipping plants into shapes is called topiary, and it can take years to do. But you can make a leafy figure by training fast-growing ivy on a wire frame. This ivy man should come to life in just months.



What you need

- Garden wire • Wire cutters • Container
- Potting soil • Shovel made from twig and foil • 2 ivy plants



1 For the head, twist two lengths of wire into ovals, leaving enough extra to make the neck.

Add shovel for support



2 Twist wire into a body shape. Leave a spike on each foot to push into the soil. Attach the head and wrap the shape with more wire.



3 Fill the container with potting soil. Push the figure in place. Place an ivy plant at each foot and thread around the frame.

174 Train a plant

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MINS



New growth

Covered shape

Plant pot

Make or buy a small topiary training frame. Put potting soil in a pot, plant a small-leaved plant, such as ivy or box, and put the frame over it. As the plant grows, keep wrapping new shoots around the frame and trim into shape.